Simulation data and settings used for the three base papers

1. Purpose

This note records the plant model, the influent data and every setting used to reimplement the three base papers. Anyone with the repository and an internet connection can regenerate every number and figure from it.

- Paper 1: D. Wang, X. Li, J. Ren, J. Qiao, "Multiagent Adaptive Critic Control With Expert Knowledge for Wastewater Treatment Plants", IEEE Trans. Ind. Informat., 2026, doi:10.1109/TII.2026.3659924.
- Paper 2: S. L. Du, P. X. Chen, H. G. Han, J. F. Qiao, "Dissolved oxygen concentration control in wastewater treatment process based on reinforcement learning", Sci. China Tech. Sci. 66(9), 2549–2560, 2023, doi:10.1007/s11431-022-2403-8.
- Paper 3: M. Zhao, D. Wang, J. Ren, J. Qiao, "Integrated Online Q-Learning Design for Wastewater Treatment Processes", IEEE Trans. Ind. Informat. 21(2), 1833–1842, 2025, doi:10.1109/TII.2024.3488790.

All three papers use Benchmark Simulation Model No. 1 (BSM1) of the IWA Task Group on Benchmarking of Control Strategies. None of them publishes code, so the plant and the data below are the public benchmark, not the authors' own files.

2. Plant model

The plant is the official BSM1 model as ported to Python by the bsm2-python package, version 0.0.16 (FAU-EVT, BSD-3 licence). That package reproduces the IWA MATLAB/Simulink implementation. We call it through src/wwtp/official/plant.py, which exposes the two inputs the papers manipulate and the two outputs they control.

Item	Value
Biological model	ASM1, 13 state variables, 8 processes, 15 °C
Reactors	5 in series: units 1–2 anoxic (1000 m³ each), units 3–5 aerated (1333 m³ each)
Secondary settler	10 layers, area 1500 m², height 4 m, feed to layer 5; Takács double-exponential settling ($v_0' = 250$, $v_0 = 474$ m/d, $r_h = 5.76\cdot10^{-4}$, $r_p = 2.86\cdot10^{-3}$ m³/g, $f_{ns} = 2.28\cdot10^{-3}$, $X_t = 3000$ g/m³)
Return sludge Q_r	18 446 m³/d (fixed)
Wastage Q_w	385 m³/d (fixed)
Internal recycle Q_a	55 338 m³/d by default; manipulated in paper 1, range 0–92 230 m³/d
Oxygen transfer	$KLa_1 = KLa_2 = 0$, $KLa_3 = KLa_4 = 240$ d^{-1}; KLa_5 manipulated, range 0–240 d^{-1}, default 84 d^{-1}
Oxygen saturation	8 g/m³
Kinetic parameters (15 °C)	μ_H 4.0 d^{-1}, K_S 10, K_OH 0.2, K_NO 0.5, b_H 0.3 d^{-1}, μ_A 0.5 d^{-1}, K_NH 1.0, K_OA 0.4, b_A 0.05 d^{-1}, η_g 0.8, k_a 0.05, k_h 3.0, K_X 0.1, η_h 0.8
Stoichiometry	Y_H 0.67, Y_A 0.24, f_P 0.08, i_XB 0.08, i_XP 0.06, TSS/COD 0.75
Controlled outputs	S_O,5 (dissolved oxygen in unit 5) and S_NO,2 (nitrate in unit 2)

Each reactor is integrated over one control period with scipy.integrate.odeint inside bsm2-python; the settler is integrated the same way. The control period is 45 s for all three papers.

3. Influent data

3.1 Source

The three standard BSM1 influent files (dry, rain and storm weather) are the IWA files Inf_dry_2006, Inf_rain_2006 and Inf_strm_2006. We take them in spreadsheet form from the public repository

davidfernand/BSM1_in_Python, commit 5dadb20 (GPL-3). They are downloaded on first use into data/official/ and are not copied into this repository.

Two checks were made against bsm2-python, which ships the dry and rain files in its own format:

- The dry file is identical in every column and every row.
- The rain file has the same flows (to 0.003 m³/d) and the same concentrations, except for one column (S_I, below).

3.2 Format

Each file covers 14 days at 15-minute intervals, giving 1345 rows from t = 0 to t = 14 d. The columns are time, the 13 ASM1 concentrations (S_I, S_S, X_I, X_S, X_B,H, X_B,A, X_P, S_O, S_NO, S_NH, S_ND, X_ND, S_ALK) and the flow rate Q. The plant needs four more columns, which we add:

- total suspended solids, TSS = 0.75 (X_I + X_S + X_B,H + X_B,A + X_P);
- temperature, 15 °C;
- five dummy states, set to zero.

Between samples the influent is held constant.

3.3 Correction made

In the spreadsheets the inert soluble COD S_I is 30 g/m³ in every row of every file. In the official rain file distributed with bsm2-python, S_I is instead diluted by the rain water. It follows S_I = 30·Q_dry/Q, and we confirmed that rule against all 1344 rows of that file to within 0.005 g/m³. We apply the same rule to the rain and storm data; for dry weather it changes nothing.

S_I is biologically inert, so this correction affects only effluent COD and the effluent quality index. It does not affect the controlled variables.

3.4 The three weathers

Weather	Week	Mean Q (m³/d)	Min–max Q (m³/d)	Flow-weighted COD (g/m³)	COD load (kg/d)	NH_4 load (kg N/d)	TSS (g/m³)
Dry	1	18 446	10 000–32 180	381	7032	582	211
Dry	2	18 451	10 000–32 180	381	7034	582	211
Rain	2	24 189	10 000–52 126	291	7034	582	161
Storm	2	21 044	10 000–60 000	352	7402	582	198

Week 1 is the same dry-weather week in all three files. In the rain file a long rain period (days 8.4–10.4) raises the flow and dilutes the influent without adding load. In the storm file two short storms (around days 8.8 and 11) bring the flow up to 60 000 m³/d with a first flush of particulate matter, which is why its COD load is higher.

4. Simulation protocol

- Initial state. Every run starts from the steady state supplied with bsm2-python.
- Warm-up. The plant is then run for 14 days on dry weather under the PID prior of the paper being reproduced:
- paper 1: KLa_5 and Q_a, set points 2 and 1 mg/L;
- paper 2: KLa_5 at a dissolved oxygen of 2 mg/L, Q_a fixed;
- paper 3: KLa_5 at 2 mg/L, Q_a fixed.

The plant state at the end of the warm-up is the start of every evaluation run, so every controller begins from the same plant.

- Evaluation. Each evaluation run covers the 14 days of the weather file in 45 s control periods (26 880 periods).
- Paper 2's split. Paper 2 learns on week 1 and is evaluated on week 2, as in that paper.
- Sensors. Sensors are ideal: no delay and no measurement noise.
- Paper 1's noise test. In the noise experiment of paper 1, zero-mean white noise with a standard deviation of 3 % of each actuator's upper bound (7.2 d^{-1} on KLa_5, 2766.9 m^3/d on Q_a) is added to the applied inputs, which are then limited to their ranges.
- Repeated runs. Repeated runs differ only in the random initial weights of the networks and, in the noise case, the noise sequence. They use seeds 0, 1, 2 and so on.

5. Settings for each paper

5.1 Paper 1, MAACC

Taken from the paper, including its Table I:

Setting	Value
Controlled variables and set points	S_O,5 = 2 mg/L via KLa_5; S_NO,2 = 1 mg/L via Q_a (see note below)
Prior strategy	incremental PID, K_p = diag(100, 100 000), K_i = diag(20, 30 000), K_d = diag(10, 1000)
Utility weights	W = (1, 2), Y = (0.5, 0.05), R = (10^{-4}, 10^{-8}), P_1 = 2I, P_2 = I; raw units
Discount, learning rates	λ = 0.95, l_c = 0.01, l_a = 0.005
Hidden units	critic 12 and 14, action network 10 and 12; bipolar sigmoid; only outer weights learn; action-network outer weights start at zero
Critic update	eq. (15)–(18) as printed (TD(0) and residual-gradient readings were also checked, with the earlier [1, 2] set points; no difference)
Runs	20 per case (dry, rain, storm, dry with noise)

A note on the set points: the text of paper 1 writes r = [1, 2] for [S_O,5, S_NO,2], but its Figs. 4–6 and 8 show S_O,5 held at 2 mg/L and S_NO,2 at 1 mg/L, the standard BSM1 values. With [2, 1] our PID reproduces the paper's PID row (dry weather oxygen IAE $1.140 \cdot 10^{-2}$ against $1.14 \cdot 10^{-2}$; storm $1.176 \cdot 10^{-2}$ against $1.17 \cdot 10^{-2}$). With [1, 2] it does not, so [2, 1] is used.

Not given in the paper and chosen by us:

- initial inner weights uniform on [−1, 1];
- initial critic outer weights uniform on [−0.1, 0.1].

A sweep of twelve other initial scales is in results/summary_paper1_exact_init_sweep.json and is summarised in docs/REPORT.md. Code: src/wwtp/maacc/exact.py, experiments/20_exact_paper1.py.

5.2 Paper 2, DDPG

Setting	Value
Control	KLa_5 only, no set point; Q_a at 55 338 m^3/d
State, action	[S_S,5, S_O,5, S_NH,5]; increment of KLa_5
Rewards	A: −(max(S_NH,e − 4, 0) + 0.38·max(N_tot,e − 18, 0)); B: −(AE + 0.42·max(S_NH,e − 4, 0))
Networks	actor 3-256-256-1 (ReLU, tanh), critic 4-256-256-1
Hyperparameters	γ 0.99, mini-batch 256, buffer 30 000, τ 0.001, learning rates 10^{-4} (actor) and $3 \cdot 10^{-4}$ (critic)
Comparators	PID on S_O,5 = 2 mg/L (K_p 200, K_i 15, K_d 2) and a fuzzy controller

Three corrections are applied in the main runs, because the agent did not learn as published on our first plant:

- the actuator setting $KLa_5/240$ is added to the state;
- each action is held for 15 minutes;

- the reward is scaled by $1 - \gamma$.

AE enters the reward as $KLa_5/240$, because the paper does not give its units. Training uses 30 passes over the learning week, with exploration noise annealed from 0.35 to 0.05 and a replay buffer of 80 000 (the paper's is 30 000). One run exactly as published is reported separately.

Code: src/wwtp/rl/, experiments/06_aeration_benchmark.py --official.

5.3 Paper 3, IOQL

Setting	Value
Control	KLa_5 only; Q_a at 55 338 m³/d
Reference	fixed, r = 2 mg/L; or dynamic, eq. (33): 2 / 2.2 / 1.8 mg/L in two-day blocks
Prior policy	PID K_p 100, K_i 20, K_d 1; for the prior study K1 (80, 15, 10), K2 (100, 30, 10), K3 (120, 25, 10) with ω = 0.99^k
Weighting	ω = 1 in the main runs
Utility	$G = e^2 + 0.01 \cdot u^2$, with e = S_O,5 − r and u = ωα + β; γ = 1
Networks	15 hidden units each, tanh; only the outer weights learn
Learning	l_c = 0.01, l_a = 0.005; 50 critic and 60 action-network training steps per control period
Runs	3 per case

Not given in the paper and chosen by us:

- initial weights uniform on [−1, 1];
- the input applied in a period is the one after that period's updates;
- u is limited to 0–240 d^{-1}.

Code: src/wwtp/ioql/ioql.py, experiments/23_ioql.py.

6. Performance measures

For a run of N control periods, with tracking error e = S − r:

- IAE = (1/N) Σ |e|
- ISE = (1/N) Σ e^2
- DEV_max = max |e|

These follow eq. (36) of paper 1 and eq. (32) of paper 3. Paper 2 uses:

- AE = (S_O,sat / 1800) Σ V_i KLa_i (kWh/d);
- the BSM1 effluent quality index EQ (kg pollution units/d);
- effluent concentrations averaged over the evaluation week.

7. Files

File	Contents
results/published_paper{1,2,3}.json	numbers typed in from each paper's tables
results/summary_paper1_exact2.json, traces_paper1_exact2.json	paper 1 runs and trajectories
results/summary_fig_p2_*.json, traces_fig_p2_*.json	paper 2 runs and trajectories
results/summary_ioql.json, traces_ioql.json	paper 3 runs and trajectories
docs/figures/reproduced/	every figure of the three papers, redrawn from these runs
docs/REPORT.md	the full comparison with the papers